

Lucas Firas Kayssi

PhD Student, York University

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Education

- ❖ BA, University of Western Ontario (2023) — London, Ontario
 - Double major: Philosophy and Economics
- ❖ MA, McMaster University (2023–2025) — Hamilton, Ontario
 - Philosophy
- ❖ PhD, York University (2025–present) — Toronto, Ontario
 - Philosophy
 - Expected completion 2030

Publications

- [1] (Co-author) “Imposing vs finding unity”, *Cognitive Neuroscience* (2024), 1-2. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17588928.2024.2405187>.
- [2] (Co-Editor) “Innovation for Social Impact”, Sandra Lapointe; Geraldine Cahill; Catherine Klausen; and Kelsey Spitz-Dietrich. [[Link](#)]

Conferences, talks, and colloquiums

- ❖ (Invited) Western University’s *Society of Neuroscience Graduate Students* panel on ChatGPT and AI, 2023
- ❖ (Invited) Windsor University’s *Being and Its Technology: Philosophical Perspectives* graduate conference
- ❖ (Co-organiser) McMaster University Graduate Student Conference, 2024
- ❖ (Co-organiser) Big Thinking Summit, October 2025
- ❖ (Co-organiser) Public Philosophy Network’s eighth conference, 2025
- ❖ Presenter for York Philosophy Graduate Research Group

Teaching, Research, and Employment Experience

- ❖ Teaching Assistantships:
 - 2CT3 Critical Thinking (philosophy department), Fall 2023

- 1BB3 Argumentation (philosophy department), Winter 2024
- 1F03 Meaning in Life (philosophy department), Fall 2024
- 1E03 Philosophical Questions (philosophy department), Winter 2025
- PHIL1000 Intro to Philosophy (philosophy department), Fall 2025–Winter 2026
- MODR 1730 Reasoning About Social Issues (philosophy department), Summer 2026
- ❖ Research Assistantships:
 - Contract with The/La Collaborative, Sept. 2024–Dec. 2025.
Supervised by Sandra Lapointe
- ❖ Communications Associate for McMaster's Department of Philosophy, 2023-2024
- ❖ In-person tutor at Tutoring Club (Streetsville, Mississauga), 2024

Scholarships and Awards

- ❖ Canada Graduate Scholarship – Master's (SSHRC CGS-M)
 - 12-months funding for Summer 2024, Fall 2024, Winter 2025.
- ❖ McMaster Graduate Scholarship
 - 12-months funding for Fall 2023, Winter 2024, Summer 2025.
- ❖ 2024-25 Graduate Teaching Assistant Award
 - Elected by my students, then reviewed and issued by McMaster's philosophy department.
- ❖ York Entrance Scholarship
 - 12-months funding for Fall 2025, Winter 2026, Summer 2026.
- ❖ York Fellowship
 - 12-months funding per academic year, starting Fall 2025.

Volunteer Contributions

- ❖ Co-editor for *The Oracle*: York University's undergraduate philosophy journal
- ❖ Creator and co-host: AGI and Philosophy Discussion Event, 2023
 - On behalf of McMaster University's philosophy department; in collaboration with the MacPherson Institute.
- ❖ Co-creator and co-host: AGI and Humanities Discussion Event, 2024
 - In collaboration with the MacPherson Institute.

- ❖ McMaster Arts & Humanities Graduate Committee Student Representative, (voting member), 2023-2024
- ❖ Student representative for the MA in Philosophy program, 2023-2024
- ❖ Co-Author of “*Towards Ethical AI Homelessness Tools*”, a white paper produced for LIFE*SPIN in London, Ontario during an Honors in Philosophy capstone course, 2023
- ❖ Member of York Philosophy Graduate Student Association
- ❖ Organiser of the York Philosophy Graduate Research Group, Winter 2026
- ❖ Judge in the 2024 Canadian Ethics Bowl
- ❖ Judge in the 2025 Canadian Ethics Bowl
- ❖ Expert training leader for the 2026 Ethics Bowl
- ❖ [Invited] Student member of the Ad Hoc Selection Committee for Associate Dean of Humanities (Graduate Studies and Research), 2024
- ❖ Social Committee Member for McMaster’s Philosophy department, 2024-2025
- ❖ Associate Vice President: Arts & Humanities Student Council, 2022-2023
- ❖ Vice President, Finance: Western University’s *School of Thought*, 2021-2022
- ❖ Vice President, Events: Western University’s *School of Thought*, 2022-2023

Other Affiliations

- ❖ [The EMRG Lab](#) – hosted at Western University’s Rotman Institute of Philosophy
 - 2022 - Present
- ❖ The Royal Society for Arts (RSA), fellow
 - 2025–2026

Completed Graduate Courses

- ❖ Philosophy of Science: Concentration on action theory
- ❖ Philosophy of Law: Concentration on Kant’s *Doctrine of Right*
- ❖ Special topics in philosophy: French Ecology
- ❖ Philosophy of Language: Concentration on *Beyond Concepts*
- ❖ Epistemology: Concentration on *The Enigma of Reason*
- ❖ Design, Collaboration and Innovation in Philosophical Research
- ❖ First-year Ph.D. seminar : Concentration of the philosophy of AI
- ❖ Philosophy of Mind: Causation in cognition and perception
- ❖ Phenomenology: Concentration on the problem of alterity

- ❖ Ethical and Societal Implications of Artificial Intelligence
- ❖ Major Figures in Political Philosophy: Concentration on West African philosophers William Blyden Edward Horton

References

- ❖ Dr. Sandra Lapointe